



» TABLE TENNIS NATIONAL CHAMPIONSHIP

DIVIDED HOUSE BUT PERFORMANCES RAISE HOPE AND DREAMS

TTFI's old fault-lines remain but the year-ending National Championship offered a **glimpse** of the future of table tennis.

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Before reflecting on the year-ending National Table Tennis Championship, it is important to know the background, dotted with the continued indifference of those trusted with running the Table Tennis Federation of India (TTFI), after the turmoil in its administration in the recent past.

If 2023 was seen as a season of hope for Indian table tennis lovers, it sadly managed to reinforce the phrase, 'the more things change, the more they stay the same.' The elected members of the TTFI, whose responsibilities were assumed by a

COMING TO THE ON-TABLE ACTION, THERE WERE SOME PREDICTABLE OUTCOMES, LIKE THE PETROLEUM MEN AND THE RESERVE BANK OF INDIA WOMEN RETAINING THE TEAM TITLES

three-member Committee of Administrators appointed by the High Court from mid-February to early December 2022, did not meet the expectations of players and other stakeholders on various levels.

Headed by Meghna Ahlawat, wife of Haryana's Deputy Chief Minister Dushyant Chautala, with eight-time singles national champion Kamlesh Mehta as the secretary-general, the new-look TTFI took charge in December 2022 after a late-night compromise was reached between the opposing groups. Hours later, a farcical election took place in New Delhi, where the voters walked into

All smiles: Petroleum's Harmeet Desai and Poymantee Baisya (Railways) pose with their trophies and medals after winning the singles titles in the National Table Tennis Championship in Panchkula. RAKESH RAO